Comment on a Policy in the Public Comment Period - January 4-7, 2024						
Time stamp	Policy	Permission to Post?	Name	Email	Your School Community	Please provide your comments below
1/6/25	New: Student Use of Personal Electronic Devices in Schools x.xx.xxx-P	Yes, without name			Benson and Grant	As a PPS parent and a science teacher in a PPS high school I have seen a decrease in students' ability to ask questions and wonder about things. I believe this phenomenon is directly associated with the use of cell phones that provide the answers to any questions 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. Students have become accustomed to turning to the internet for information rather than observing phenomenon and testing hypothesis. These skills are a required part of the science curriculum that PPS students are expected to engage with. Phone use has affected the willingness of students to 'do science'. Another part of 'doing science' is communicating with classmates by sharing and listening to ideas. When phones are not in the classroom I have seen students become more willing to be engaged in conversation with one another.
1/7/25	New: Student Use of Personal Electronic Devices in Schools x.xx.xxx-P	Yes, with name	Eleanor Isles		Grant High School	I strongly oppose the implementation of Yondr pouches in our schools. While reducing distractions is important, forcibly removing students' access to their phones is not the solution. Smartphones are essential tools for modern learning, safety, and communication. For many students, phones serve as learning aids, allowing us to access online resources, manage schedules, and collaborate with peers. They also provide a critical sense of security, ensuring we can contact family or seek help in emergencies. Restricting this access disregards the realities of our digital age and fosters resentment rather than engagement. Rather than forcing compliance through restrictive measures, we should focus on fostering mutual trust and responsible phone use through education and clear expectations. Let's address the root causes of distraction without alienating students or creating unnecessary tension. I urge you to reconsider this policy and collaborate with students to find solutions that respect our needs while achieving your goals.